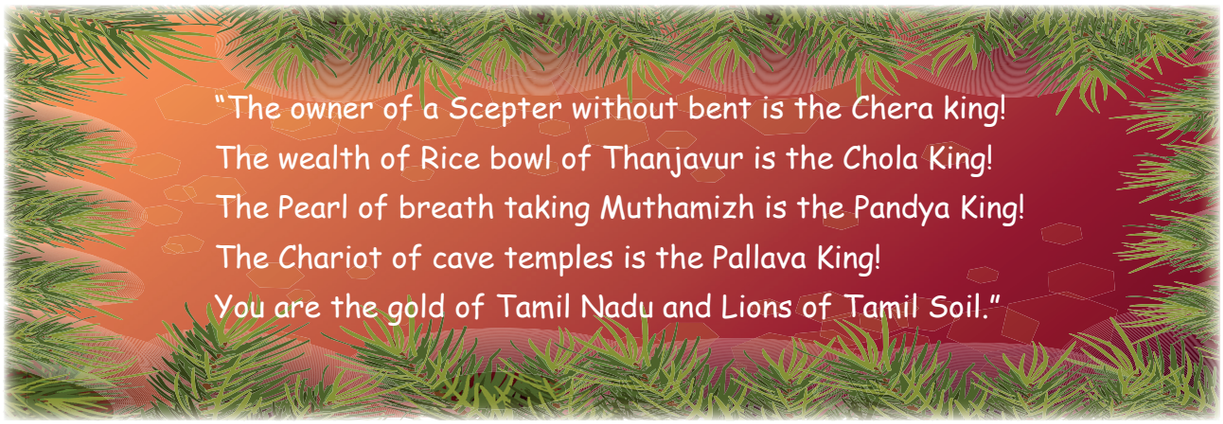


Introduction

In the ancient period, people settled and started living along the river banks.

They produced agricultural crops. They reared cattle in the pasture lands. In this way the kingdoms of early Chera, Chola, Pandya and other kingdoms emerged along the rivers.

Kingdoms		River Banks
Cheras	-	Poigai
Cholas	-	Cauvery
Pandyas	-	Vaigai
Pallavas	-	Palar

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Cheras

Cheras were the forerunners of the 'Moovendhargal' who ruled on the banks of river Poigai and their capital city was Vanji.

The Chera country comprised of the present western districts of Erode, Tirupur, Coimbatore and Nilgiris. Kerala was also a part of it. The Chera country was called Cheranadu.

The major part of the Cheranadu was surrounded by high mountains. The greatest rulers among the kings of Cheranadu were Imayavaramban Neduncheralathan and his son Senguttuvan.

The Chera King, Neduncheralathan conquered upto the Himalayas and hoisted the flag with the symbol of Bow and Arrow. Therefore he was hailed with the title "Imayavaramban Neduncheralathan".

The able ruler Cheran Senguttuvan, erected the statue of Kannagi. This temple of Kannagi was built by the stones brought from the Himalayas after defeating king Kanaka Vijaya. It is also said that these stones were brought to Cheranadu on the heads of the captive soldiers.

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